
Paper 3, Option 39.2: Mass media and social change in Britain, 1882–2004

Overview

This option comprises two parts: the *Aspects in breadth* focus on long-term changes and contextualise the *Aspects in depth*, which focus in detail on key episodes.

Together, the breadth and depth topics explore the ways in which the mass media developed from the end of the nineteenth century to the first years of the twenty-first century, alongside the profound changes that occurred within the family as women's roles and family leisure opportunities changed, a time of dramatic change that altered forever how the British people viewed themselves. Whilst mainly social and cultural, this option also gives students the opportunity to explore the impact of key political events and legislation.

Aspects in breadth: social change – family, home and leisure, 1882–2004	
Themes	Content
1 Changing patterns of women's lives within the family and in the world of work	• Changes to women's personal lives, 1882–2004 (key developments: the Married Women's Property Act 1882, Marie Stopes' family-planning clinics from 1921, the NHS 1948, the contraceptive pill from 1961, the Abortion Law Reform Act 1967, the end of the 'composite tax system' 1991, the first 'Take our Daughters to Work' day 1994); the reasons for, and impact of, government legislation and shifts in attitudes to women's roles. • Reasons for changes in women's working lives, 1882–2004; the impact on women's roles of direct action, legislation and changing attitudes (key developments: the matchgirls' strike 1888, the National Service Act 1941, the women's strike at Dagenham Ford car factory 1968, the Equal Pay Act 1970).
2 Changing patterns of family leisure	• Change and continuity in leisure, 1882–2004: entertainment in the home; changes in excursions and holidays (key developments: the first Butlin's holiday camp 1936, Holiday Pay Act 1938, foreign package holidays from the 1950s). • Reasons for change in leisure patterns, 1882–2004: impact of changes in means of transport (key developments: the safety bicycle from the late 1880s, increasing car ownership in the 1920s, growth of air travel from 1950s); the impact of increasing affluence and reduced time at work; the impact of technology (key developments: cinema in the early twentieth century, radio from the 1920s, TV from 1945 and the use of the internet for leisure from the late twentieth century).

Aspects in depth: mass media: mirroring or moulding society?	
Key topics	Content
1 The age of the press barons, 1914–36	- The influence of Beaverbrook and Northcliffe; Northcliffe's stance on conscription and criticisms of some conduct of the war; Beaverbrook's undermining of Asquith and support for Lloyd George, and involvement in the abdication crisis. - The importance of Rothermere: his newspaper empire and expansion, the newspaper war, 1928–29; his influence, including support of revisions to First World War treaties, clash with Baldwin in 1931, support for Moseley and the BUF. - The importance of the <i>Daily Herald</i>: the role of George Lansbury; the significance of the editorial stance on the First World War, conscientious objectors and the Russian Revolutions; the impact of Kamenev's telegram 1920.
2 Wireless and the war: propaganda, information and entertainment, 1939–45	- Reporting the war: the impact of broadcasts from the front; Churchill's speeches on the BBC and his relationship with the Corporation; the nature of censorship. - Broadcasting to the home front: advice and information; popular light entertainment; the role of government ministries; relationship between entertainment and morale; public attitudes to the BBC. - The impact of propaganda broadcasts: the role of Lord Haw Haw and Sefton Delmer.
3 Media in the sixties: satire image and social change	- The significance of satire in changing attitudes to government, monarchy and the church. - The importance of film and television in engaging with, and reflecting, social issues and prejudices, including racism, sexism and homelessness; Mary Whitehouse and the NVALA. - The 'Swinging Sixties' media image; the 60s' icons; the reality of the society and economy of the 1960s.
4 The Thatcher governments and the media, 1979–90	- The principles underpinning the Thatcher governments' policies and their significance for the media industry. - The promotion of competition in broadcasting: the launch of Channel 4 in 1982; the growth of local and commercial radio. - Control and compliance: attempts to control reportage on issues of national security; the role of Bernard Ingham; the reportage of the Falklands conflict and the miners' strike.
5 The Labour government versus the media: the problem of the Iraq dossiers, 2002–04	- The impact of dossier claims and the press briefing of February 2003; reportage in the media; the impact of the Channel 4 investigation into the accuracy of the dossiers. - Confrontation between the government and the BBC; the reaction of the media; the roles of Alastair Campbell and Andrew Gilligan; the impact of the death of Dr Kelly.

Coursework

Overview

The purpose of this coursework is to enable students to develop skills in the analysis and evaluation of interpretations of history in a chosen question, problem or issue as part of an independently researched assignment.

The focus is on understanding the nature and purpose of the work of the historian. Students will be required to form a critical view based on relevant reading on the question, problem or issue. They will also be specifically required to analyse, explain and evaluate the interpretations of three historians.

The coursework will be assessed using a centre-set assignment. Assignments must meet the requirements detailed below. An assignment framework is provided to support the development of individual assignments.